

Serious—what is happening inside the brains of the "AI is bad for environment" folks?

Posted by u/lsc84 • • 0 points • 42 comments

We have all seen the various demented claims about AI guzzling up lakes to make AI-generate content, or using extreme amounts of energy. It is simply not possible that the people posting such things could have missed the myriad and constant corrections against this ridiculous misinformation. But the claims continue unabated.

What is happening inside the brains of the people who insist on repeating such obvious lies? Are they in the grip of some kind of psychosis, are they lying on purpose, or is something else wrong with them?

Comments

u/Yamurkle • 1 points • 2025-11-09 14:43 UTC

I asked AI

An AI search like ChatGPT uses approximately 10 times more energy per query than a traditional Google search.

Here's a breakdown of the comparison:

⚡ Energy Usage Per Query			
Metric	Google Search	ChatGPT (AI Search)	Multiple
Energy per query	0.0003 kWh	0.0029 kWh	~10×
CO ₂ emissions per query	0.2g	68g	~340×
Daily energy usage	~10.8 MWh	~621.4 MWh	~58×
Annual home equivalent	~2,000 homes	~21,600 homes	~11×

Sources:

- 🧠 Why the Difference?
- AI models like ChatGPT require far more computational power to generate responses, involving large neural networks and multiple GPUs.
 - Google Search is optimized for retrieving indexed data, which is computationally lighter.

So while AI offers richer, more conversational results, it comes with a significantly higher energy cost. If

you're thinking about sustainability in tech, this is a key trade-off. Want to explore how this scales with usage or how companies are trying to reduce the footprint?

u/Sad_Low3239 • 1 points • 2025-10-26 23:06 UTC

late to the party, but i seen somewhere that those who have interests in the power sectors want hysteria with power demand and AI, because they can then go to congress and say "Think of all the blackouts that will happen and listen to the people! let us mass build all these cheap gas and coal plants so that wont happen!" because the exact same thing happened when the internet was born - all this media saying it will suck all the electricity from the grid and it (the grid) would collapse.

u/Turbulent_Escape4882 • 1 points • 2025-10-24 10:27 UTC

It helps put correction of AI hallucinations in perspective.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-10-24 07:49 UTC

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u/Adventurekateer • 1 points • 2025-10-24 07:40 UTC

Nothing. Nothing at all.

u/Crazy_Yogurtcloset61 • 1 points • 2025-10-24 06:52 UTC

I mean, I think that's one very valuable anti-A.I. argument to be honest. While one individual using A.I. Isn't particularly impactful, the more and more people use it, the more and more it hurts the environment.

It's not too different from cars. Driving a car from one person isn't that bad, but as more and more people get on the road, the worse things get.

My personal take is, cars have become more fuel efficient and more environmentally friendly over time.

We are still in the early stages of A.I. getting used more and more. I feel confident that in 20-30 years despite having more users, we will actually see less of an environmental impact over time.

u/GNUr000t • 2 points • 2025-10-24 04:54 UTC

Nothing. That's the problem.

They get their programming from tiktok and twitter/bluesky and execute it faithfully. There is no thinking to be had. They are barely human. The irony.

u/Techwield • 6 points • 2025-10-24 04:06 UTC

They're desperate to stop or slow AI and are grasping at straws trying to find something, anything they can use to discourage people from using/developing it further. It's absolutely not working though, AI apps continue to be the number one most downloaded apps every single month on every single app store, normies don't really give a shit. Which is hilarious. All that time and effort hating on AI wasted. Ahahahaha

u/Burner_Miner_Dril • 7 points • 2025-10-24 03:57 UTC

Its AI derangement syndrome